

this case, it's not quite twice as fast (which is what I've seen in other chart pattern types).

Comparing the two bear market columns, we see price rise 25% in 91 days and drop 22% in 37 days. If price dropped as fast as it climbed, it should have taken 80 days to drop 22%. In this case, price drops more than twice as fast in bear markets as it rises.

How many change trend? This is a measure of how many broadening tops see price move more than 20% away from the breakout price. I like to see values above 50%, but only one of the columns qualifies.

[Table 11.3](#) shows failure rates for broadening tops. I found that 18% of broadening tops in bull markets after upward breakouts fail to see price rise more than 5%. That's how you read the table.

Here's another example. Just over half (52%) of patterns in bull markets with downward breakouts fail to see price drop more than 10%. Notice how quickly failure rates increase.

Bear markets with downward breakouts have the lowest failure rate initially, 9%, but the edge over bull markets with up breakouts does not last long. For moves of 15% and higher, bull markets with upward breakouts maintain a lower failure rate.

How is this information useful? Imagine that the measure rule predicts price will climb from 40 to 50, a 10-point rise. That's a move of 25%. How many broadening tops in bull markets, on average, will see price rise more than 25%? Answer: 46%. To put it another way, 54% of them will fail to see price rise more than 25%.

[Table 11.4](#) shows breakout-related statistics for broadening tops.

Breakout direction. In bull markets, price breaks out upward most often. In bear markets, the breakout direction is random.